

Word family: **space / spaces / spacious / spaciousness / spacing / spatial / spatially**

Base word: space

Plural: spaces

Related forms: spacious, spaciousness, spacing, spatial, spatially

Useful expressions / extensions: outer space, space station, personal space, living space, office space, parking space, leave space, space out, cyberspace

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adjective and adverb family (相關形容詞及副詞)

Your sentence:

> “One minute, the living room becomes a **space station**...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **space** appears in the compound:

> **space station**

and means:

> **outer space; the region beyond Earth’s atmosphere**

Leo imagines the living room as a station in space.

繁體中文：**外太空；地球大氣層以外的宇宙空間**

中文翻譯：**

> “The living room becomes a space station.”

「客廳變成了一個**太空站**。」

Here:

space = 外太空 / 宇宙空間

1. **space = outer space (外太空) — 太空；宇宙空間**

This is the exact sense underlying your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The living room becomes a **space station**.”

「客廳變成了一個**太空站**。」

Practice 2

> “Humans have sent many satellites into **space**.”

「人類已經把很多衛星送入**太空**。」

Practice 3

> “Scientists study how people live in **space**.”

「科學家研究人類如何在**太空**生活。」

space = 地球大氣層以外的宇宙空間

2. **space station** (太空站) — 太空站

This is your exact compound.

Practice 4

> “Astronauts live and work on the **space station**.”

「太空人住在**太空站**並在那裡工作。」

Practice 5

> “The children pretended the room was a **space station**.”

「孩子們假裝房間是一個**太空站**。」

space station = 在太空中運行、供太空人生活、工作或進行研究的設施

3. **space** = empty area / available room (空間) — 空間；地方

A major everyday meaning.

Practice 6

> “There isn’t enough **space** for another table.”

「沒有足夠**空間**再放一張桌子。」

Practice 7

> “We need more **space** to work.”

「我們需要更多**工作空間**。」

space = 可供人、物或活動佔用的空地方

4. **space** = physical distance between things (間距) — 距離 ; 間隔

Practice 8

> “Leave some **space** between the chairs.”

「椅子之間留一些**空位 / 距離**。」

Practice 9

> “There should be more **space** between the words.”

「字與字之間應該有更多**間距**。」

space = 兩個物件、文字或位置之間的空白距離

5. **space** = blank area on a page/screen (空白位) — 空白 ; 空位

Practice 10

> “Write your name in the **space** below.”

「在下面的**空位**填上你的名字。」

Practice 11

> “There isn’t enough **space** on the page.”

「頁面上沒有足夠**空白位置**。」

****space = 紙張、表格或螢幕上未被文字 / 圖像佔用的區域****

6. ****space = place for a particular use (特定用途的位置) — 位子 ; 地方****

Practice 12

> “We found a parking ****space****.”

「我們找到了一個****泊車位****。」

Practice 13

> “The building has plenty of office ****space****.”

「這棟大樓有很多****辦公空間****。」

****space = 為某種特定用途預留或可使用的位置 / 範圍****

7. ****parking space (泊車位) — 停車位 ; 泊車位****

Practice 14

> “Is there a free ****parking space**** nearby?”

「附近有空的****泊車位****嗎？」

Practice 15

> “She parked in the last available ****space****.”

「她泊進最後一個可用的****車位****。」

****parking space = 專門供一輛車停泊的位置****

8. ****living space (居住空間) — 生活空間 ; 居住空間****

Practice 16

> “The apartment has limited ****living space****.”

「這個單位的**居住空間**有限。」

Practice 17

> “They redesigned the house to create more **living space**.”

「他們重新設計房子，以增加**生活空間**。」

living space = 供人日常居住、活動和生活使用的空間

9. **personal space (個人空間) — 個人空間；私人距離**

A major social/psychological extension.

Practice 18

> “Some people need more **personal space** than others.”

「有些人比其他需要更多**個人空間**。」

Practice 19

> “He stood too close and entered my **personal space**.”

「他站得太近，進入了我的**私人距離 / 個人空間**。」

personal space = 一個人希望他人不要隨意侵入的身體周圍私人距離 / 心理空間

10. **space = privacy / freedom to be alone (私人空間 / 自由) — 空間；喘息空間**

A figurative extension.

Practice 20

> “I need some **space** to think.”

「我需要一點**自己的空間**來想清楚。」

Practice 21

> “Give her some **space**.”

「給她一點**私人空間 / 別逼得太緊**。」

****space = 暫時不受干擾、可以獨處、思考或冷靜的心理 / 人際空間****

11. ****space = opportunity / freedom for development (發展空間) — 空間 ; 餘地****

Practice 22

> “Children need ****space**** to be creative.”

「孩子需要****空間****發揮創意。」

Practice 23

> “The project gives students ****space**** to experiment.”

「這個項目給學生****自由發揮的空間****。」

****space = 讓某人發展、探索、表達或嘗試的自由和餘地****

12. ****space = area in text/layout/design (版面空間) — 版面 ; 留白****

Practice 24

> “The design uses white ****space**** effectively.”

「這個設計有效運用了****留白****。」

Practice 25

> “There is too much empty ****space**** on the page.”

「頁面上有太多****空白位置****。」

****space = 版面設計中未被文字、圖像或其他元素佔用的區域****

13. ****white space (留白) — 留白 ; 空白空間****

Practice 26

> “Good use of **white space** makes a page easier to read.”

「善用**留白**能令版面更容易閱讀。」

Practice 27

> “The poster needs more **white space**.”

「這張海報需要更多**留白空間**。」

white space = 設計中刻意保留的空白區域，用來改善清晰度和視覺平衡

14. **space** = interval in time (時間間隔) — 間隔；一段時間

A less common but established sense.

Practice 28

> “The two events happened within a short **space** of time.”

「兩件事在很短的**時間間隔**內發生。」

Practice 29

> “A lot changed in the **space** of a year.”

「短短**一年之內**發生了很多變化。」

space = 一段時間或兩件事之間的時間間隔

15. **in the space of** + time (在……之內) — 在短短……內

Practice 30

> “The city changed completely in the **space** of ten years.”

「城市在短短**十年間**完全改變了。」

Practice 31

> “He answered three questions in the **space** of a minute.”

「他在短短**一分鐘內**回答了三條問題。」

in the space of X = 在某段有限時間之內

16. **space = area/domain of activity (領域) — 領域；市場空間**

A modern figurative/business/technology use.

Practice 32

> “Several companies are entering the AI **space**.”

「有幾間公司正進入人工智能這個**領域**。」

Practice 33

> “She works in the education technology **space**.”

「她在教育科技**領域**工作。」

space = 某個產業、技術、商業或活動領域

Register:

> modern business/technology usage

17. **cyberspace (網絡空間) — 網絡空間；虛擬空間**

A major lexical extension.

Practice 34

> “The information spread quickly through **cyberspace**.”

「資訊很快在**網絡空間**傳播。」

Practice 35

> “Privacy is an important issue in **cyberspace**.”

「私隱是**網絡空間**中的重要議題。」

****cyberspace = 由互聯網、數碼網絡和線上互動形成的虛擬環境****

18. ****space — verb = arrange with gaps (隔開) — 留間距 ; 分隔****

Now ****space**** functions as a verb.

Practice 36

> ****“Space” the chairs evenly.**

「把椅子****均勻地隔開****。」

Practice 37

> ****“The plants should be spaced one metre apart.”**

「植物之間應該****相隔一米****。」

****space things = 安排物件之間保持一定距離****

19. ****space out = arrange at intervals (間隔安排) — 分散安排 ; 隔開****

Practice 38

> ****“Space out” the meetings throughout the week.**

「把會議****分散安排在一星期不同時間****。」

Practice 39

> ****“The trees are evenly spaced out.”**

「樹木之間的****間隔很平均****。」

****space out something = 令各項事物之間保持一定時間 / 距離間隔****

20. ****space out = lose concentration (走神) — 發呆 ; 走神****

A common informal phrasal meaning.

Practice 40

> “Sorry, I **spaced out** for a moment.”

「不好意思，我剛才**走神了一下**。」

Practice 41

> “He tends to **space out** when he is tired.”

「他累的時候很容易**發呆 / 走神**。」

****space out = 暫時失去集中力，腦袋放空或沒有留意周圍事情****

Register:

> informal

21. ****spacious = having lots of room (寬敞的) — 寬敞的；空間大的****

The main adjective family member.

Practice 42

> “The living room is bright and **spacious**.”

「客廳明亮而**寬敞**。」

Practice 43

> “They moved into a **spacious** apartment.”

「他們搬進一個很**寬敞的單位**。」

****spacious = 有大量可用空間，不擠迫的****

22. ****spaciousness = quality of having plenty of space (寬敞感) — 寬敞；空間感****

Practice 44

> “Large windows add to the **spaciousness** of the room.”

「大窗戶增加了房間的**寬敞感**。」

Practice 45

> “I like the **spaciousness** of the design.”

「我喜歡這個設計的**空間感**。」

****spaciousness = 某地方顯得寬敞、開放、有大量空間的特質****

23. ****spacing = distance between items (間距) — 間距；間隔****

Practice 46

> “Check the **spacing** between the lines.”

「檢查行與行之間的**間距**。」

Practice 47

> “The **spacing** of the chairs is uneven.”

「椅子的**間距**不平均。」

****spacing = 物件、文字或事件之間所保持的距離 / 間隔****

24. ****spatial = relating to space/position (空間的) — 空間的；位置關係的****

A useful academic/technical family member.

Practice 48

> “The task tests **spatial awareness**.”

「這項任務測試**空間感知能力**。」

Practice 49

> “Children develop **spatial skills** through play.”

「孩子透過玩耍發展**空間能力**。」

****spatial = 與物體在空間中的位置、距離、方向或排列有關的****

25. ****spatial awareness (空間感知) — 空間感 ; 空間意識****

Practice 50

> “Building with Lego can improve ****spatial awareness****.”

「玩 Lego 可以提升****空間感知能力****。」

Practice 51

> “Good ****spatial awareness**** helps when driving.”

「良好的****空間感****對駕駛有幫助。」

****spatial awareness = 理解自己及物件在空間中的位置、距離和方向關係的能力****

This actually connects nicely to Leo's building activities.

26. ****spatially = in terms of space/position (在空間上) — 空間上 ; 位置上****

Practice 52

> “The objects are ****spatially**** separated.”

「這些物件在****空間上****彼此分開。」

Practice 53

> “The information is organized ****spatially****.”

「資訊按****空間位置****來組織。」

****spatially = 就位置、距離、方向或空間關係而言****

Important distinction: ****space vs room****

This is the biggest everyday contrast.

space

= broad idea of available area/capacity.

room

can mean:

1. a physical enclosed room;
2. available space.

Compare:

> “We need more space.”

= 我們需要更多空間。

> “We need another room.”

= 我們需要多一個房間。

For available capacity:

> “There isn’t enough room.”

and:

> “There isn’t enough space.”

often overlap.

Important distinction: **space = outer space vs space = available area**

Outer space:

> “Humans travel into space.”

= 人類進入太空。

Available area:

> “There isn’t enough space.”

= 沒有足夠空間。

Same word, completely different contextual meaning.

Your passage uses the first inside:

> **space station**.

Important distinction: **space vs place**

space

emphasizes:

> area/capacity.

place

emphasizes:

> location or particular position.

> “There’s not enough space.”

= 空間不夠。

> “This is a nice place.”

= 這是一個好地方。

Important distinction: **space vs area**

area

= a defined region/section.

space

= available or empty extent.

> “a play area”

= 指定的遊戲區

> “space to play”

= 可供玩耍的空间

Important distinction: **space** vs **distance**

space

can refer to the empty interval between things.

distance

specifically measures how far apart they are.

> “Leave some space between the chairs.”

does not specify exact measurement.

> “The distance between them is two metres.”

does.

Important distinction: **space** vs **gap**

gap

usually means:

> a break/opening between two things.

space

is broader and may simply mean available area.

A gap can be a space, but **space** need not be a gap.

Important distinction: **space** vs **outer space**

In ordinary English:

> **space**

without an article can already mean outer space.

> “Astronauts live in space.”

We do not normally say:

> “in the space” ❌

unless referring to a specific physical area previously identified.

Important distinction: **space station vs spaceship**

space station

= stays in orbit/space for people to live and work.

spaceship / spacecraft

= vehicle used for travel through space.

So:

> station = place/facility

> spacecraft = vehicle

Important distinction: **space station vs satellite**

space station

is designed for people to live/work aboard.

satellite

is any object placed in orbit, often unmanned.

A space station is technically an artificial satellite, but learner-facing vocabulary should keep the everyday distinction clear.

Important distinction: **space = physical room vs personal space**

Physical:

> “There is space beside me.”

= 我旁邊有空位。

Personal:

> “I need some space.”

= 我需要一點私人空間 / 不要逼我。

The second is figurative/social.

Important distinction: **personal space vs privacy**

personal space

often means:

> preferred physical/interpersonal distance.

privacy

means:

> freedom from observation, intrusion, or disclosure.

They overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction: **give someone space vs leave someone alone**

give someone space

= reduce pressure/contact and allow them independence or time.

leave someone alone

= stop interacting with them, often more strongly.

> “Give her some space.”

can still imply continued support from a distance.

Important distinction: **space for improvement vs room for improvement**

Both are possible, but:

> **room for improvement**

is the much more established idiom.

Space for improvement can occur but sounds less idiomatic in ordinary English.

Important distinction: **white space vs empty space**

white space

is a design term:

> intentionally unused visual area.

empty space

simply means:

> an area containing nothing.

White space can be coloured; it does not literally have to be white.

Important distinction: **space — business sense vs physical space**

Physical:

> “office space”

= 辦公空間

Industry:

> “the AI space”

= AI 領域

The business/technology use metaphorically treats an industry as an area people can “enter.”

Important distinction: **space out — arrange vs lose concentration**

Arrangement:

> “Space out the chairs.”

= 把椅子分開排列。

Concentration:

> “I spaced out.”

= 我走神了。

Same phrasal verb, very different meaning.

Important distinction: **spacious vs roomy**

Both mean:

> 寬敞的

spacious

often sounds slightly more formal and emphasizes abundant open space.

roomy

is more conversational and often used for:

* cars

* bags

* apartments

* clothing

Important distinction: **spatial vs spacious**

These are easy to confuse.

spacious

= has lots of space.

> a spacious room

spatial

= relating to position/space relationships.

> spatial awareness

So:

> spacious ≠ spatial

Family-extension note

Space is a strong polysemy word with several genuine modern semantic centres:

- * **outer space**
- * **available physical area**
- * **distance/gap**
- * **blank area**
- * **designated place/slot**
- * **personal/private space**
- * **figurative freedom/opportunity**
- * **time interval**
- * **business/technology domain**

The family sweep adds:

- * **spacious**
- * **spaciousness**
- * **spacing**
- * **spatial**
- * **spatially**

and useful lexical extensions such as:

* **space station**
* **personal space**
* **white space**
* **living space**
* **cyberspace**
* **space out**

The key is to distinguish genuinely different concepts while grouping contextual variants that still mean **available extent/capacity**. That follows the manual's broad-search and conservative-splitting rule.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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space — outer space	地球大氣層以外的宇宙空間
space station	在太空中運行、供太空人生活 / 工作 / 研究的設施
space — available area	可供人、物或活動佔用的空地方 / 範圍
space — distance	兩個物件、文字或位置之間的空白距離
space — blank area	紙張、表格或螢幕上未被內容佔用的區域
space — designated place	為某種特定用途預留或可使用的位置
parking space	專供一輛車停泊的位置
living space	供人日常居住和活動使用的空間
personal space	一個人希望他人不要隨意侵入的私人距離 / 心理空間
space — privacy/freedom	可獨處、思考、冷靜或不受干擾的空間
space — opportunity	讓某人發展、探索、表達或嘗試的自由 / 餘地
white space	版面中刻意保留、改善清晰度和平衡的空白區域
space — time interval	一段時間或兩件事之間的時間間隔
in the space of X	在某段有限時間之內
space — field/domain	某個產業、技術、商業或活動領域
cyberspace	由互聯網和數碼網絡形成的虛擬環境
space — verb	安排物件之間保持一定距離
space out — arrange	把事物按距離 / 時間分散安排
space out — concentration	暫時失去集中力、走神或發呆
spacious	有大量可用空間、不擠迫的
spaciousness	某地方顯得寬敞、開放的程度 / 感覺
spacing	物件、文字或事件之間的距離 / 間隔
spatial	與位置、距離、方向或空間關係有關的
spatially	就空間位置 / 關係而言

For your original sentence

> “One minute, the living room becomes a **space station**, and the next it turns into a jungle...”

The exact meaning is:

space = 地球大氣層以外的外太空 / 宇宙空間

Therefore:

> **space station**

= **「太空站」**

This is not:

* **more space** = 更多空間

* **personal space** = 個人空間

* **parking space** = 泊車位

* **white space** = 留白

* **the AI space** = AI 領域

In the passage, Leo is imagining the living room as a facility **in outer space**, which fits the playful world-building theme perfectly.